

IndiaFOSS 2026 — General Track

Wholesomeness Assessment

A narrower companion to the full programme assessment, scoped to only the Programme-Committee-curated General Track and Workshop day.

This is not an official FOSS United or IndiaFOSS publication. It is an independent, AI-assisted analysis produced for internal discussion. Only publicly available data was used — the schedule, published CFP proposal pages, and other public FOSS United pages. No authenticated organiser dashboards were accessed. Session classification involved a single AI analyst's judgment calls (see Methodology) and should be read as one considered reading, not ground truth.

Scope note. IndiaFOSS 2026's programme has two curation layers: the **General Track** — including Talks, Lightning Talks, Invited Talks, Panels, BoFs, and the pre-conference **Workshop day** — is selected end-to-end by the conference's Programme Committee (PC). The eight half-day **devrooms** (AOSP, Cloud & DevOps, Compilers, Design, Documentation & Technical Writing, Hardware, RTOS, Security) are independently curated, with the PC only approving which devroom proposals to run. This document assesses **only** the 63 PC-curated General Track and Workshop sessions — 46% of the conference's 138 scheduled sessions. It does not repeat the devroom-inclusive analysis already covered in the companion report, [if2026-summary.pdf](#), which remains the full-programme assessment.

Executive summary

Taken on its own, the General Track (55 sessions) plus the pre-conference Workshop day (8 sessions) — 63 sessions, 2,835 minutes, roughly 47 hours of programme time — reads as a genuinely mixed-format track rather than a pure talk stack. Talks and Lightning Talks together are the majority by session count (41 of 63), but by *time* the single largest block is the Workshop day (960 of 2,835 minutes, 34%), with Birds-of-a-Feather sessions a close third behind Talks (645 minutes, 23%). One session (the Communi-Con lightning slot) is a placeholder whose actual content is picked by community vote after its CFP opens on 25 September, so it sits outside classification below.

Two structural facts shape every finding in this document. First, because the eight technically deep devrooms (kernel/OS/hardware/compiler work) sit entirely outside this scope by design, the General Track is thin on deep technology-stack layers — 20 of 63 sessions (32%) carry no stack-level tag at all, because they are BoFs, panels, or process/community talks rather than technical builds. That is a division-of-labour artifact between PC and devroom curation, not a weakness of the General Track itself, and it should not be read as one. Second, within its own remit, the General Track carries most of the conference's public-interest and policy content — Legal/Policy tags appear on 8 sessions, anchored by a coherent digital-public-infrastructure thread (Judiciary Entity Map, DPI panel, NHA1 government-workflow talk, G2C Oracle-to-Postgres migration, Software Patents, and a Copyleft-for-AI-data BoF) that does not depend on any devroom to exist.

Gap analysis — at a glance

• Well represented (within this scope)

- Public-interest / govtech / policy thread: judiciary, DPI, NHA1, G2C migration, software patents, data-copyleft — 8+ sessions, spanning Talks, a Panel, and BoFs
- The Workshop day: 8 sessions, 960 minutes, the most hands-on and technically varied block in this scope (Qt, OCaml, AI agents, OpenStreetMap, self-hosting, creative coding, live-coding music, digital security)
- Community-process reflection: 20 sessions (BoFs, panels, "how we built our community" talks) turn the General Track into a genuine discussion venue, not only a stage
- Government-employee and business-people audiences are both better served here (16 and 18 session-tags respectively) than a talk-only reading of "general track" would suggest

• Thin or missing (within this scope)

- Designer-facing content: only 3 audience-tags across 63 sessions carry "designers" — categories.md names designers explicitly as a target audience, and this scope barely reaches them (Design has its own devroom, outside this scope)
- Education/Academia as a genuine academic-research domain: the 9 tagged sessions are mostly student-group self-promotion (COSH, DevCom) or teaching tools, not research talks — actual researcher-facing academic content leans on the Research tag instead (14 sessions)
- Deep technology-stack layers (Kernel, Firmware, Operating System): only 6 tags combined — expected, since that work is devroom territory, but worth naming so nobody mistakes "shallow stack coverage" here for a conference-wide gap
- Structured takeaways from BoFs/Panels: 13 sessions, 765 minutes (27% of this scope) are open-ended discussion format with no defined output artifact — a real opportunity, not a defect

Tags are the AI analyst's per-session judgment calls against the categories.md schema (Domain, Suitability for Audience are multi-value fields); percentages are of this document's 63-session scope, not the full 138-session conference.

1. Format mix: not just a talk track

Format	Sessions	Minutes	% of scope minutes
Workshop	8	960	34%
Talk	26	780	28%
Birds of a Feather (BoF)	11	645	23%
Lightning Talk	15	285	10%
Panel Discussion	2	120	4%
Invited Talk	1	45	2%
Total	63	2,835	100%

By session count, Talks and Lightning Talks dominate (41 of 63, 65%), which is what "general track" conjures for most attendees. But minutes tell a different story: the Workshop day alone claims more programme time than either Talks or BoFs. A reader judging the General Track purely by its talk list would miss over a third of its actual footprint.

2. Domain coverage

Domain	Session-tags
Community	35
Industry	19
Research	14
Not-for-Profit Sector	11
Government	10
Education/Academia	9
Legal/Policy	8

Domains are multi-tagged, so totals exceed 63. Community dominates, unsurprising for a track that includes every BoF and most "how we grew our project/community" talks. The Legal/Policy figure (8) is worth pausing on: unlike in the full-programme report where policy content had to be found scattered inside the General Track and Workshop day, here it is the General Track and Workshop day's own content — this scope is where all of the conference's software-patents, community-data-licensing, and civic-tech-policy conversation actually lives.

3. Overall category and technology-stack depth

Overall category	Sessions
Software	31
FOSS Philosophy/Principles	20
Data	9
Hardware	2
Not yet determined (Communi-Con, CFP opens 25 Sep)	1

A full third of this scope (20 of 63) classifies as FOSS Philosophy/Principles rather than Software, Data, or Hardware — almost entirely the BoFs, the Panel discussions, and community-process talks. That is exactly what a PC-curated general track ought to look like: it is the layer of the conference explicitly designed to host discussion-format and reflective content, while the devrooms carry the hands-on technical depth. Of the 43 sessions that do carry a stack-level tag, Application dominates (34); Kernel, Firmware, and Operating System combined account for only 6 tags — Frappe/Zasper/frappe-ui-style application and framework work is well represented, but nothing at the lower layers of the stack, which is squarely devroom territory (AOSP, RTOS, Hardware, Compilers) and outside this document's scope.

Depth and novelty

Across the 62 sessions that could be scored (Depth of technical coverage and Novelty vs. existing work, both 1–10): average depth 5.0, average novelty 5.1, full range 1–8. The 12 lowest-depth sessions (≤ 3) are all BoFs, panels, or reflective community talks — low technical depth is the expected, correct reading for that format, not a quality signal. The highest-depth sessions in this scope (OpenTCAD's semiconductor simulation pipeline at 8, the FQ-PIE networking-standard talk at 8, Rapier physics engine internals at 8) show the General Track can still carry serious engineering content when a talk chooses to.

4. Audience coverage

Audience	Session-tags
software developers	41
researchers	18
business people	18
government employees	16
hackers	15
social workers	12
educators/professors	6
graduate/master level students	6
designers	3

Software developers are, unsurprisingly, the primary audience almost everywhere. What stands out is how much reach this scope has beyond that default: government employees and business people are each named on more sessions than hackers, driven by the govtech/policy cluster and the startup-survival and pay-competitiveness talks. Designers are barely present (3 tags) — categories.md names designers explicitly as a target audience for this schema, and within this scope's own remit there is little built for them (Design has its own devroom outside this scope, which is the more natural home, but it means a designer scanning only the General Track and Workshop day would find almost nothing pitched at them).

5. The Workshop day, in detail

All eight pre-conference workshops run 120 minutes and sit inside this scope. They are the most technically diverse cluster here: Qt desktop GUI development, live-coding music with strudel.cc, hands-on digital security for journalists and activists, functional programming in OCaml, creative coding with p5.js, building AI agents end-to-end, an outdoor OpenStreetMap mapping session, and a real-time self-hosting/homelab workshop. Where the rest of the General Track is built for listening and discussion, the Workshop day is the one place in this scope

where attendees install something, build something, or go outside and map something — worth naming as this scope's strongest "come do something" offering.

6. Reach: who gets the biggest room, within this scope

This edition adds a per-session **reach** figure — the seat capacity of the room each session runs in. Within this document's 63-session scope, reach splits cleanly by format: the 19 sessions in Hall 1 (840 seats) and 25 in Hall 2 (250 seats) are ordinary Talks and Lightning Talks; the 11 BoFs all run in the 35-seat Room 2/3; and all 8 Workshops run in the dedicated Workshop Venue (35–40 seats). No session in this scope runs in a 120-seat room — that tier belongs entirely to the 8 devrooms this document excludes (see [if2026-summary.pdf](#), Section 12, for the full-programme reach picture, where every devroom session is capped at exactly that 120-seat tier). Within this scope, reach and format are almost perfectly correlated: a session's format predicts its reach more reliably than its depth, novelty, or topic does. The one wildcard is Communi-Con — a 75-minute, content-undetermined lightning slot booked into Hall 1, making it the single highest-reach session in this entire scope despite having no describable content as of this report (see Section 3's placeholder note).

7. What this document deliberately does not claim

Because this document's scope excludes all eight devrooms, several gaps that would appear glaring here — thin Kernel/OS/Hardware coverage, no dedicated design-tooling talks, limited RTOS or compiler content — are not conference-wide gaps at all; they are handled elsewhere, by design, in independently-curated devrooms. Readers should treat this document as an answer to "is the PC's own curated slice of the programme wholesome," not "is IndiaFOSS 2026 as a whole wholesome" — the latter question is [if2026-summary.pdf](#)'s to answer, and it draws on all 138 sessions including the eight devrooms this document sets aside.

Methodology note

Session set: the 55 sessions on the schedule's "General Track" sheet (which itself already bundles Talks, Lightning Talks, an Invited Talk, Panels, and BoFs — schedule sheets are organised by devroom, not by format) plus the 8 pre-conference Workshop-day sessions, identified the same way as the main report: each schedule title matched to a CFP proposal ID via `schedule/cfp-info.csv`, and the proposal's own page at `fossunited.org/c/indiafoss/2026/cfp/<ID>` fetched for its Session Description, Session Type, and duration. Classification against all seven categories.md dimensions (Platform, Domain, Level in Technology Stack, Overall category, Depth, Novelty, Suitability for Audience) was done fresh for this document's 63-session scope by the same single AI analyst convention used in the main report: one reading per session from its own proposal description, not independently cross-checked, and reported as multi-value tags separated by ";" where categories.md's own "etc" wording invited more than one value. The one exception is the Communi-Con lightning-talk slot (75 minutes), whose content is picked by community vote after its own CFP opens on 25 September 2026 — it has a confirmed slot and duration but no describable content yet, so it is excluded from every category breakdown above and shown as "not yet determined" in the full table that follows.

Categories.md, verbatim, for reference (see the companion `if2026-summary.pdf` for the full appendix mapping): Platform: embedded, mobile, desktop, web, etc · Domain: Education/Academia, Not-for-Profit Sector, Government, Research, Community, Industry, Legal/Policy, etc · Level in Technology Stack: Hardware, Firmware, Kernel, Operating System, Frameworks/Middleware, Libraries, Application, etc · Overall category: Hardware, Software, Data, FOSS Philosophy/Principles, etc · Depth of technical coverage: 1–10 · Novelty compared to existing work: 1–10 · Suitability for Audience: graduate/master level students, designers, hackers, professionals, researchers, software developers, educators/professors, social workers, government employees, venture capitalists, business people, etc.

Full Session Table — General Track & Workshop Day (63 sessions)

All 63 PC-curated General Track and Workshop-day sessions, classified against the categories.md schema. Sorted by format, then duration. Title links to the original CFP proposal. Multi-value fields separated by ",". The Communi-Con slot's content is picked by community vote after its own CFP opens 25 Sep 2026, hence "—" and "N/A" throughout.

Format	Session	Min	Reach	Platform	Domain	Stack Level	Category	Depth	Novelty	Audience
Talk	From Pull Requests to Patients: Building Open Healthcare Infrastructure in the Open	30	840	web	Not-for-Profit Sector;Government	Application	Software	6	5	software developers, social workers, government employees
Talk	From Institution to Community: Building COSH and a Culture of Open Source	30	840	N/A	Education/Academia;Community	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	3	educators/professors, graduate/master level students
Talk	Textbooks that run: interactive, zero-install CS education in the browser	30	840	web	Education/Academia	Application;Frameworks/Middleware	Software	6	6	educators/professors, software developers
Talk	Tracking-free and hackable network cameras - powered by libre software	30	840	embedded	Community;Industry	Firmware	Hardware	7	6	hackers, software developers
Talk	Building OpenSpeaks tools for language documentation and archiving	30	840	web;desktop	Research;Community	Application	Software	5	6	researchers, software developers
Talk	Open Code, Curated Data: Building Open Water Intelligence for Indian Cities	30	840	web	Government;Community	Application	Data	6	6	government employees, researchers, software developers
Talk	Building Zasper: Inception to Growth	30	250	desktop	Community;Industry	Application	Software	7	6	software developers
Talk	Repub: Launching the Open Post-Processing Workflow for Digital Archiving in India	30	250	web	Not-for-Profit Sector;Research	Application	Software	5	6	researchers, software developers
Talk	How to Build Long-Lasting Tech Communities That Thrive — A Playbook	30	250	N/A	Community	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	3	business people, software developers
Talk	Optimizing Performance of GUIs	30	250	embedded;desktop	Industry	Libraries;Frameworks/Middleware	Software	7	6	software developers, hackers
Talk	FOSS for the Forgotten Middle: Open-Sourcing Finance Software for India's 50,000 Microgyms	30	250	web;mobile	Industry;Community	Application	Software	5	6	business people, software developers
Talk	Navigating the FOSS Contribution Journey	30	250	N/A	Community	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	3	software developers, graduate/master level students
Talk	How FOSS and AI are Changing Government Workflows at NHA	30	250	web	Government	Application	Software	5	6	government employees, software developers
Talk	Offline-first mobile apps on Frappe: a metadata-driven Flutter SDK with server-side control	30	250	mobile	Industry	Frameworks/Middleware	Software	7	6	software developers
Talk	Physics at 60FPS	30	250	desktop;web	Community;Industry	Libraries	Software	8	7	software developers, hackers
Talk	How India's Largest G2C Platform Migrated to FOSS and Broke Free from Oracle	30	840	web	Government;Industry	Application;Frameworks/Middleware	Software	7	5	government employees, software developers, business people
Talk	How exactly can we teach students the right FOSS etiquette?	30	840	N/A	Education/Academia;Community	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	4	educators/professors, graduate/master level students

Talk	Seqout: search engine for the world's genomic data	30	840	web	Research	Application	Data	7	7	researchers, software developers
Talk	How we build Community Projects from the Community for the Community	30	840	web	Community	Application	Software	4	4	software developers, business people
Talk	Flexibility is complexity in disguise: Building frappe-ui for 10+ Products	30	840	web	Industry	Frameworks/Middleware;Libraries	Software	7	6	software developers
Talk	Surviving as an Open Source Startup : Xeneva	30	250	embedded;desktop	Industry	Kernel;Operating System	Software	6	5	business people, software developers, hackers
Talk	Computationalizing landscapes: The CoRE stack data structure for social-ecological diagnostics and planning	30	250	web	Research;Government;Not-for-Profit Sector	Application	Data	7	7	researchers, government employees
Talk	Freedom to code - Community's role in tech Policy	30	250	N/A	Legal/Policy;Community	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	6	5	business people, government employees, software developers
Talk	Calibrate: A framework for continuously evaluating and improving AI agents within non-profits	30	250	web	Not-for-Profit Sector;Industry	Application	Software	6	7	software developers, researchers
Talk	Being Bayesian: Stress-testing India's Loudest Stories with FOSS & Open Data	30	250	web	Research;Community	Application	Data	6	6	researchers, business people
Talk	Judiciary Entity Map: How open source can make India's courts legible	30	250	web	Government;Legal/Policy;Not-for-Profit Sector	Application	Data	6	7	researchers, government employees, business people
Lightning Talk	Communi-Con : CFP opens 25th Sep	75	840	N/A	Community	N/A	N/A (content not yet determined)	—	—	N/A
Lightning Talk	Fork Around and Find Out: How I Built a GNOME Extension Used by 200K+ People	15	840	desktop	Community	Application	Software	4	3	software developers, hackers
Lightning Talk	It takes a village to raise a repo	15	840	N/A	Community	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	3	software developers, social workers
Lightning Talk	FQ-PIE: Contributing to Open Standards by Contributing to FOSS	15	250	N/A	Research;Industry	Kernel;Operating System	Software	8	7	researchers, software developers
Lightning Talk	Mapping India in seconds, for one and all	15	250	web	Research;Government	Application	Data	5	5	researchers, government employees
Lightning Talk	What can we do about open weight models enabling non consensual intimate imagery?	15	840	N/A	Research;Legal/Policy	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	5	7	researchers, social workers, government employees
Lightning Talk	Opening the Archives: Building Digital Infrastructure for Public Participation in Archival Records	15	840	web	Not-for-Profit Sector;Research	Application	Data	5	6	researchers, software developers
Lightning Talk	Don't Model Every Leaf: The Magic of Blender Geometry Nodes	15	250	desktop	Community	Application	Software	5	4	designers, hackers
Lightning Talk	Property-based testing for UIs	15	250	web;mobile	Industry	Application;Libraries	Software	6	6	software developers
Lightning Talk	OpenTCAD: A FOSS Python Pipeline for Semiconductor Process and Device Simulation	15	250	desktop	Research;Industry	Application	Hardware	8	8	researchers, hackers
Lightning Talk	Open, decentralized language assessment software for the public school system	15	250	mobile;embedded	Education/Academia;Government	Application	Software	6	7	educators/professors, government employees

Lightning Talk	Bad Internet, Good Software	15	250	desktop	Community	Application	Software	5	4	hackers, software developers
Lightning Talk	Open Standards in XR - A current overview of OpenXR and WebXR	15	250	mobile;desktop;web	Industry;Community	Frameworks/Middleware	Software	5	4	software developers
Lightning Talk	Software Patents - AI and the Future of Open Innovation	15	250	N/A	Legal/Policy	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	5	5	business people, government employees, software developers
Lightning Talk	Building Open Source Digital Infrastructure for a University	15	250	web;mobile	Education/Academia;Community	Application;Frameworks/Middleware	Software	6	5	software developers, graduate/master level students
Invited Talk	Telling India's story through data	45	840	web	Research;Community	Application	Data	5	5	researchers, business people, government employees
Panel Discussion	From DPI to People's Digital Infrastructure: Reclaiming Digital Infrastructures for Democratic Accountability	60	840	N/A	Government;Legal/Policy;Community	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	5	government employees, social workers, researchers
Panel Discussion	The future of FOSS, SWE and Technical Education	60	840	N/A	Education/Academia;Industry	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	6	educators/professors, software developers, business people
Birds of Feather(BoF)	Do Open Source Companies Pay Competitively?	60	35	N/A	Industry	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	4	software developers, business people
Birds of Feather(BoF)	FOSS and Co-operatives	60	35	N/A	Legal/Policy;Community	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	5	business people, social workers
Birds of Feather(BoF)	FOSS4Good - Techies in the social sector	60	35	N/A	Not-for-Profit Sector;Community	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	4	social workers, software developers
Birds of Feather(BoF)	FOSS in the Public Consciousness	60	35	N/A	Community	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	2	3	business people, social workers, software developers
Birds of Feather(BoF)	Can We Build a Copyleft License for Community Data in the Age of AI	60	35	N/A	Legal/Policy;Research	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	5	7	researchers, business people, government employees
Birds of Feather(BoF)	Micro-granting in India	60	35	N/A	Not-for-Profit Sector;Community	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	4	business people, social workers
Birds of Feather(BoF)	Community-Driven or Community-Branded? Who Gets to Shape Community Events?	60	35	N/A	Community	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	3	business people, software developers
Birds of Feather(BoF)	Community-Centred Technology	60	35	embedded;mobile	Not-for-Profit Sector;Community	Application	Software	4	6	social workers, researchers
Birds of Feather(BoF)	How do we scale and sustain AI adoption without burning the planet?	60	35	N/A	Research;Industry	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	6	researchers, business people, government employees
Birds of Feather(BoF)	FOSS for Justice — What can Open Source do for India's Courts?	60	35	N/A	Government;Legal/Policy;Not-for-Profit Sector	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	5	government employees, social workers, software developers
Birds of Feather(BoF)	United by (Free) F&B – Food & Books	45	35	N/A	Community	N/A	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	1	2	software developers, hackers
Workshop	Getting Started with Qt	120	38	desktop	Community;Industry	Frameworks/Middleware	Software	5	3	software developers, hackers
Workshop	Making music with strudel.cc	120	38	web	Community;Education/Academia	Application	Software	4	6	hackers, designers, graduate/master level students
Workshop	Digital Security for Journalists, Activists, and Everyday Internet	120	38	mobile;desktop	Not-for-Profit Sector;Community	Application	Software	5	4	social workers, hackers

	Users: A Hands-On FOSS Workshop									
Workshop	Fun and Profit with OCaml	120	38	desktop	Education/Academia;Research	Application;Libraries	Software	6	5	software developers, graduate/master level students
Workshop	Art - meet Math - meet Code	120	38	web	Education/Academia;Community	Application	Software	4	5	designers, hackers, educators/professors
Workshop	Building AI agents end-to-end: A hands-on workshop	120	38	web	Industry	Application;Frameworks/Middleware	Software	6	6	software developers
Workshop	Adding places to OpenStreetMap (outdoor workshop)	120	38	mobile	Community	Application	Data	3	3	hackers, social workers
Workshop	Self-Hosting 101: A real-time self-hosting workshop	120	38	desktop	Community	Application;Operating System	Software	5	3	hackers, software developers